OLIcyber – Web 4
HTTP Request: Accept Header

The goal of this challenge is to request the resource `http://web-04.challs.olicyber.it/users`using the Alternative representation `application/xml`instead of the default `application/json`..

This challenge instructs to access a specific webpage in the format of **application/xml** instead of **application/json**

OLIcyber – Web 4
The Accept Request Header

The goal of this challenge is to request the resource `http://web-04.challs.olicyber.it/users`using the Alternative representation `application/xml`instead of the default `application/json`..

The HTTP Accept header instructs the server what kind of response it should send back to the client

OLIcyber – Web 4
The Accept Request Header

```
> GET /users HTTP/1.1
> Host: web-04.challs.olicyber.it
> User-Agent: curl/8.18.0
> Accept: */*
```

In most cases, when we make a request to a webpage, we accept */*, which means we will accept any content type in response

OLIcyber – Web 4
The Content-Type Response

```
Common Content-Type Values

text/html                  ⟵ webpages
application/javascript     ⟵ JavaScript files
application/json           ⟵ JSON (JavaScript) files
application/xml            ⟵ XML files
```

A server sends an HTTP response, which contains a Content-Type header that indicates what kind of data it is sending back

OLIcyber – Web 4
The Content-Type Response

```
< HTTP/1.1 406 Not Acceptable
< Content-Length: 95
< Content-Type: text/plain; charset=utf-8
< Date: Wed, 25 Mar 2026 04:42:16 GMT
< Server: nginx/1.21.6
<
* Connection #0 to host web-04.challs.olicyber.it:80 left int
act
Not acceptable. Acceptable representations for this resource:
 application/json, application/xml
```

Many URLs can return different types of content in response to a request, and may send back an error response if you don't select a valid one

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OLIcyber – Web 4
Solve method 1: Web Browser


```
−<users>
  −<user comment="[redacted]">
      <name>admin</name>
      <role>admin</role>
      <registration_date>2018-06-18T15:34:55Z</registration_date>
    </user>
```


The challenge webpage returns the XML content by default, so this is the easiest way to complete the challenge

OLIcyber – Web 4
Solve method 2: Curl

```
curl                                ⟵ the program itself
-v                                  ⟵ return verbose output
-H "Accept: application/xml"        ⟵ specific Accept header
```

Solving this challenge with Curl requires us to send specific **Accept** request header with **application/xml** as the value using the -H argument

OLIcyber – Web 4
Solve method 3: Python

```python
import requests

URL = 'http://web-04.challs.olicyber.it/users'

custom_headers = {'Accept': 'application/xml'}

get_req = requests.get(URL, headers=custom_headers)
req_text = get_req.text
print(req_text)
```

Solving this challenge with Python requires us to use the Request module's get() method with the headers parameter to supply the specific Accept header